Cisplatin, lomustine and vincristine (CLV)

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00806 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Taking the treatment

Take lomustine only once on the authorised Day 1. The pharmacist must confirm the total dose, capsule strengths, how to take it and anti-sickness timing. Do not open or crush capsules or take another dose to replace a missed or vomited one without advice. Cisplatin and vincristine are given into a vein. Day 1 includes fluids before and after cisplatin; later visits on Days 8 and 15 are for vincristine. The total visit is longer than the infusion itself.

STEP 2

Missed, vomited or held medicine

If a capsule dose is missed or vomited, call the oncology team or pharmacist before taking more. Do not double up or use leftover capsules. An infusion or capsule held for toxicity needs a new team decision.

STEP 3

Medicine and supplement review

Bring all prescription, over-the-counter and herbal medicines, vitamins and supplements to review. Include steroids, seizure medicines, anticoagulants and any recent antibiotics or antifungals. Tell the team before starting or stopping a medicine.

STEP 4

Capsule supply and handling

Lomustine is supplied as an unlicensed medicine in this NCCP protocol. Confirm pharmacy supply in advance. Keep the labelled pack away from children and do not open or crush capsules. Return unused chemotherapy to the pharmacy; contact staff if swallowing or handling is difficult.

STEP 5

Pregnancy, breastfeeding and fertility

Discuss fertility preservation and contraception before starting. Treatment can harm a pregnancy. Do not breastfeed during treatment. Ask for the written medicine-specific precautions and the required periods after stopping; these may differ between products.

STEP 6

Appointments and transport

Before starting: Blood count, kidney/liver tests; hearing assessment and creatinine clearance when clinically indicated; NCCP lung testing for patients at high risk. Current lomustine SmPC additionally advises baseline lung-function assessment. Current cisplatin product information advises baseline audiometry. Confirm recovery after radiotherapy (RT) and the individual hydration/electrolyte plan. During treatment: Regular blood count, kidney/liver tests, with hearing and lung assessment when indicated. Current lomustine SmPC advises weekly blood counts for at least six weeks after a dose and continuing lung assessment. Current cisplatin product information additionally advises weekly kidney/liver tests, blood counts and electrolytes through treatment, with repeat hearing testing for symptoms. Review nerves and bowel function before vincristine. Brain/spine imaging and any other response tests follow the individual specialist plan; no universal scan or tumour-marker timetable is set here.

STEP 7

Help with the daily plan

Agree help with prescriptions, travel, calls and symptom notes if fatigue, memory, sight or weakness makes these difficult. Your preferences guide who is involved. Keep the printed plan and real urgent contacts together.

Sources: NCCP 00806 v2 · current regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.